

Creating your Own Linux Distro

Since the first Linux distribution was released way back in 1992 (MCC Interim Linux by Manchester University's Owen Le Blanc), there have been hundreds of ways to get the world's favourite free software operating system on to a computer. The diversity of alternatives reflects the diversity in the development community, with distros split along technical, functional, linguistic and even ideological lines. There have been large distros, tiny ones, bleeding edge and rock-solid stable distros, easy for the newbie to install, or downright impenetrable to the uninitiated.

So with all the variety that's already out there, why would anyone want to create their own distro? After working with our first Linux distro years ago, we'd discover there were issues we definitely would've liked to see improved upon. We tried a number of alternative distributions to address these issues, yet each has its pros and cons.

You would use your current Linux system to develop your own customised system. This "perfect" Linux system would then have the strengths of various systems without their associated weaknesses. In the beginning,

the idea was rather daunting, but we remained committed to the idea that a system could be built that would conform to my needs and desires rather than to a standard that just did not fit what we were looking for. Anyway, creating something, from noodles to a complex web site is rewarding and satisfying – especially if you love the end result. The feeling of being in control, trying out new ideas and then seeing your goals realised can't be beaten. This is one of the joys of computing, especially programming, with the open source world a constant generator of code, concepts and communities upon which to build. And creating your own customised Linux distro, however difficult this may seem initially, is one of the best ways to combine

We believe if you want absolute satisfaction from your Linux system, you should build your own